

A Machine-Checkable Operational Standard for Systemic Tau τ_s and the Discrete Extramental Clock (RECD)

Lean 4 formalization, laboratory constructions,
and open scrutiny program (v0.1.8)

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Abstract

We present `systemic-tau-formal` v0.1.8, an open monorepository that states the operational core of the Systemic Tau (τ_s) paradigm and the Discrete Extramental Clock (RECD) in a form accepted by a formal verifier. The Lean 4 + Mathlib package encodes regime bands, the gate function $g(\tau_s)$, partition and monotonicity lemmas, and a laboratory construction package that links the operational criterion to period-doubling cascade ideas and Feigenbaum's constant δ . The artifact is accompanied by a Python reference core, golden rational bridges, continuous integration, and a citable Zenodo deposit.

What is offered is not a closed narrative of dynamical universality, but a verifiable operational standard: an explicit decision rule, a machine checker that accepts it, and an open door to public scrutiny. Laboratory maps and scale identifications are presented as named, cited constructions, not as field theorems.

Keywords: systemic tau; RECD; early warning signals; Lean 4; Mathlib; formalization; complex systems; Feigenbaum; open science.

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1 Introduction

Frameworks that speak of synchrony, regime, and warning in complex systems are often communicated as intuition, diagram, or black-box software. That weakens three requirements of open science: knowing exactly what is asserted; allowing a third party to repeat the judgment without relying on the author’s authority; and separating the decision criterion from the empirical and ontological readings that surround it.

The Systemic Tau paradigm reads multivariate coherence through an index τ_s —the mean of windowed Kendall-type rank correlations—and a Discrete Extramental Clock (RECD) whose gate $g(\tau_s)$ translates that index into a regime signal. This preprint records an *operational standard* together with a *laboratory construction package*. It is not a proof of classical Feigenbaum universality. It is not a derivation of field τ_s dynamics from first principles of a physical continuum.

The methodological thesis is simple: the operational core must be writable in a form that a formal verifier accepts. The monorepository `systemic-tau-formal` realizes that thesis. It exposes definitions, lemmas, and constructions in Lean 4; aligns a Python reference core; and deposits citable versions with DOIs. Version 0.1.8 under `SystemicTau/` builds with no sorry holes and no author-added research axioms. That is how the paradigm presents itself: as an auditable criterion.

Relative to v0.1.7, this release closes former research holes as named laboratory constructions (including a non-tent continuous return). It adds logistic scale identification and a C^2 /Schwarzian package, and aligns the honesty documentation with the formal pin.

2 What is offered to the community

The repository conveys a concrete message:

1. **There is an explicit decision criterion.** Regime bands and the gate law g are written down; they do not remain only in prose.
2. **That criterion is accepted by a formal checker.** Anyone with the Lean toolchain can clone the repository, run `lake build`, and obtain the same acceptance verdict as the author.
3. **The bridge to period-doubling dynamics is materialized as formal objects.** Named laboratory constructions—maps, strong-unimodality packages, quadratic tip, Schwarzian, scale identification with a geometric cascade—are accepted by the checker.
4. **The work is presented as open infrastructure.** Code, continuous integration, versioned releases, and DOIs make the artifact citable and reproducible.
5. **The paradigm invites scrutiny.** A challenge board, an experimental protocol, and a stress-test invitation provide routes for attacking the standard by layers.

In one sentence: the paradigm is no longer only a discourse; it is offered as shared, inspectable infrastructure.

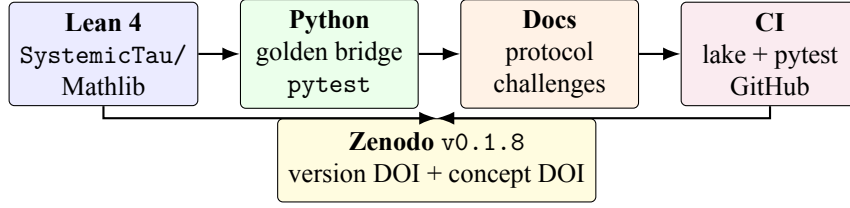


Figure 1: Architecture of the monorepository: formal core, reference implementation, documentation and scrutiny surfaces, continuous integration, and citable deposit.

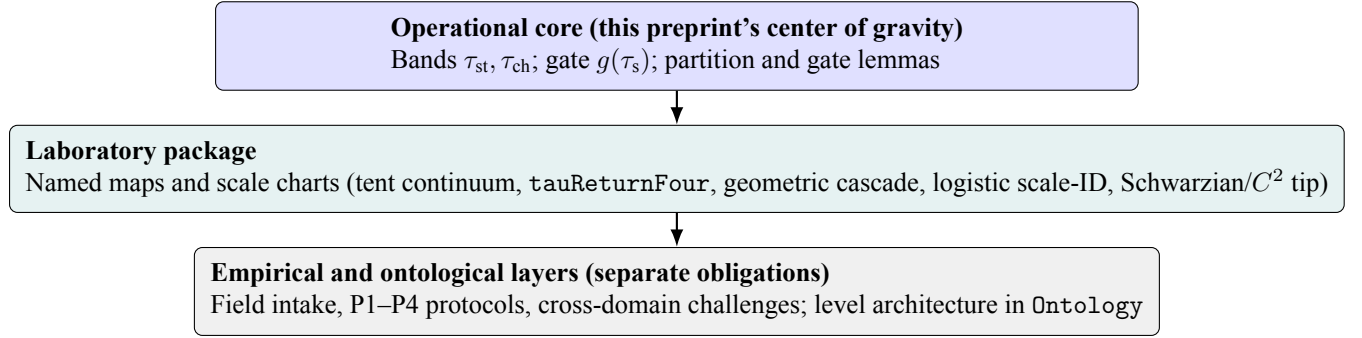


Figure 2: Discourse layers. The checker verdict on the operational core and laboratory package is kept distinct from field validation and ontological discussion.

3 Operational definitions

3.1 Systemic Tau

Consider a multivariate series and a sliding window of length W (default $W = 13$ in the reference core). On each window, Kendall-type rank correlations [8] are computed between variable pairs; τ_s denotes the mean over those pairs. In Lean, the interface fixes rational types and an opaque symbol `kendallTau` for the combinatorial implementation. The remainder of the formalization reasons about $\tau \in \mathbb{Q}$ without depending on a particular numerical backend.

3.2 Regime bands

The standard fixes two rational thresholds:

$$\tau_{\text{st}} = \frac{1}{2}, \quad (1)$$

$$\tau_{\text{ch}} = \frac{41}{100}. \quad (2)$$

Regime classification on $\tau \in \mathbb{Q}$ is summarized in Table 1 and Figure 3:

$$\text{stable} \quad \text{if } \tau \geq \tau_{\text{st}}, \quad (3)$$

$$\text{chaotic} \quad \text{if } -\tau_{\text{ch}} < \tau < \tau_{\text{ch}}, \quad (4)$$

$$\text{antiSync} \quad \text{if } \tau \leq -\tau_{\text{ch}}, \quad (5)$$

$$\text{intermediate} \quad \text{otherwise.} \quad (6)$$

Table 1: Operational regime bands (exact rationals), matching Lean classify.

Regime	Condition on τ	Notes
stable	$\tau \geq \tau_{\text{st}}$	$\tau_{\text{st}} = 1/2$
intermediate	$\tau_{\text{ch}} \leq \tau < \tau_{\text{st}}$	$\tau_{\text{ch}} = 41/100$; residual of the cases below
chaotic	$-\tau_{\text{ch}} < \tau < \tau_{\text{ch}}$	open interval
antiSync	$\tau \leq -\tau_{\text{ch}}$	left-closed ray

On the nonnegative ray, an exhaustive trichotomy is proved: every $\tau \geq 0$ falls into chaotic, intermediate, or stable, mutually exclusively under these definitions. The inequality $\tau_{\text{ch}} < \tau_{\text{st}}$ is also established.

3.3 Operational Feigenbaum constant

A laboratory rational approximation

$$\delta_{\text{op}} = \frac{46692016091}{10000000000} \approx 4.6692016091$$

is introduced. Explicitly: δ_{op} is a *fixed* rational approximation to classical δ , obtained by truncating the tabulated expansion to ten decimal places ($4.6692016091 \dots \mapsto 46692016091/10^{10}$), following high-precision values in the period-doubling literature [1, 2]. The numerator and denominator are encoded as naturals in Lean (`feigenbaumDeltaNum/feigenbaumDeltaDen`); the package does not claim that this rational is the unique “best” approximant, only that it is the operational pin used throughout. The gate prefactor is

$$p = \frac{\delta_{\text{op}} - 1}{\delta_{\text{op}}}.$$

Lean checks $0 < p < 1$. The proximity quantity $2/\delta_{\text{op}}$ satisfies

$$2/\delta_{\text{op}} > \tau_{\text{ch}},$$

with an explicit positive rational gap $2/\delta_{\text{op}} - \tau_{\text{ch}}$ (order 10^{-2}). That proximity motivates the chaotic band without imposing a closed identity $\tau_{\text{ch}} = f(\delta)$.

4 The RECD gate

The reference gate law $g : \mathbb{Q} \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}$ is defined piecewise by

$$g(\tau) = \begin{cases} +1, & \text{if } \tau \geq \tau_{\text{st}}, \\ p \cdot \frac{\tau_{\text{ch}} - |\tau|}{\tau_{\text{ch}}}, & \text{if } |\tau| < \tau_{\text{ch}}, \\ -1, & \text{if } \tau \leq -\tau_{\text{ch}}, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (7)$$

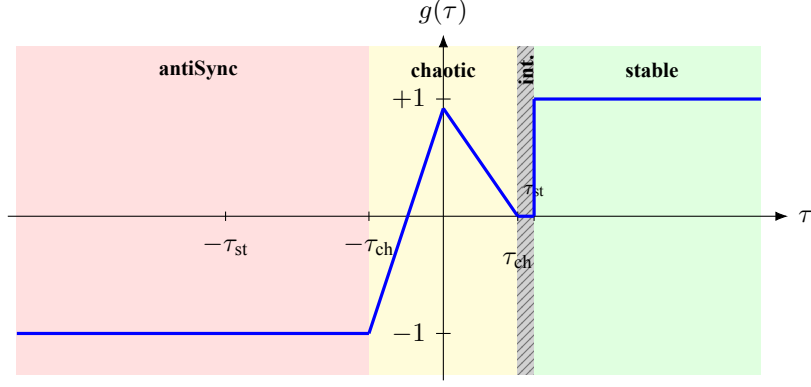


Figure 3: Schematic of operational bands on the τ -axis and the piecewise gate $g(\tau)$ from Equation (7). The narrow hatched strip is the positive intermediate band where $g = 0$. Note the asymmetric treatment of the anti-synchronous ray ($g = -1$) relative to that strip.

Formal properties included in the core (and accepted by Lean) include:

- **Closed form on $[0, \tau_{\text{ch}})$.** Equation (7) reduces to $g(\tau) = p(\tau_{\text{ch}} - \tau)/\tau_{\text{ch}}$.
- **Antitonicity (non-increasing on the positive chaotic ray).** If $0 \leq a \leq b < \tau_{\text{ch}}$, then $g(b) \leq g(a)$. As τ grows toward the band edge, the nonnegative gate value does not increase. Since $g \geq 0$ on that ray, the same holds for $|g|$: magnitude is non-increasing in τ .
- **Boundedness.** From the piecewise law: $|g(\tau)| \leq 1$ for every regime. Stable and antiSync saturate at ± 1 ; the chaotic piece is $p \in (0, 1)$ times a factor in $(0, 1]$, hence strictly below 1 except at the origin, where $g(0) = p$.
- **Exact zero on the positive intermediate band.** $\tau_{\text{ch}} \leq \tau < \tau_{\text{st}}$ implies $g(\tau) = 0$.
- **Edge samples and regime links.** $g(3/4) = 1$, $g(-3/4) = -1$, $g(45/100) = 0$, $g(0) = p$; $g(\tau) = 1$ for all $\tau \geq \tau_{\text{st}}$; $g(\tau) = -1$ for all $\tau \leq -\tau_{\text{ch}}$. Local evenness holds inside the open chaotic band ($g(-\tau) = g(\tau)$ when $|\tau| < \tau_{\text{ch}}$), but the law is *not* globally even: the anti-synchronous ray opens at -1 while the positive intermediate band stays closed at 0.
- **Piecewise character.** On $\mathbb{Q}$, g is a finite piecewise-rational function of τ and $|\tau|$. Each piece is affine in τ (or constant). Jumps appear only at the band boundaries encoded in Equation (7) (notably $\tau = \pm\tau_{\text{ch}}$ and $\tau = \tau_{\text{st}}$).

Numerical illustration. Table 2 lists a short synthetic walk of τ_s values and the corresponding gate signal under Equation (7) (with $p = (\delta_{\text{op}} - 1)/\delta_{\text{op}}$). Figure 4 plots the same walk.

Table 2: Synthetic τ_s walk and gate response (rational arithmetic).

t	τ_s	Regime	$g(\tau_s)$
1	0.55	stable	+1
2	0.48	intermediate	0
3	0.30	chaotic	$p \cdot (0.41 - 0.30)/0.41$
4	0.10	chaotic	$p \cdot (0.41 - 0.10)/0.41$
5	0.00	chaotic	p
6	-0.20	chaotic	$p \cdot (0.41 - 0.20)/0.41$
7	-0.45	antiSync	-1
8	0.60	stable	+1

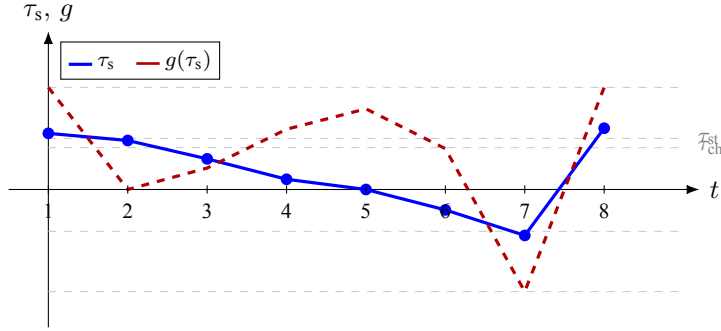


Figure 4: Synthetic eight-step walk of τ_s (solid) and the RECD gate $g(\tau_s)$ (dashed). Intermediate positive τ_s keeps the gate closed; antiSync opens it at -1 ; high coherence saturates at $+1$.

5 Feigenbaum laboratory package

Beyond the gate, the repository develops a package of *laboratory constructions*. They connect the language of τ_s to unimodal dynamics and the period-doubling cascade [1, 3, 4]. The constructions live in dedicated Lean modules and build together with the core.

5.1 Reduction and return maps

The first laboratory layer asks a concrete question: which maps may stand in, inside the checker, for a return of a coherence-like coordinate? The reduction module answers with named objects rather than prose: realizers of functional pairs, a laboratory continuum based on the tent map, and a continuous non-tent return `tauReturnFour` (logistically conjugate on a coherence interval). A composite package then pairs that return with a refined `FeigenbaumUniversal` object (operational δ -band and quadratic tip). The scientific claim at this layer is modest: the bridge exists as citable, verified constructions—not as informal narrative.

5.2 Analytic cascade and topology

Once return maps are available, the package freezes a geometric parameter cascade whose exact ratio is δ_{op} . Scaling ratios of that cascade are proved equal to δ_{op} . Within the formalism, the classical ε - N notion

of cascade limit is shown equivalent to a Tendsto-style convergence statement, so topological language and sequential bookkeeping stay aligned. Honesty blocks include toy cascades that do *not* approach δ_{op} ; the checker therefore distinguishes models that satisfy the scaling ratio from those that do not.

5.3 Logistic scale identification

The logistic chart is the usual first contact for readers of one-dimensional dynamics. A dedicated module anchors a parameter sequence at landmarks $r_0 = 2$, $r_1 = 3$ and proves that this sequence shares scale (ratios) with the geometric cascade above. It is a laboratory scale identification between two parameter charts, expressed in Lean: not a claim that field τ_s is logistic, but a shared ruler for later comparison.

5.4 Quadratic tip and Schwarzian

Classical route-to-chaos arguments rely on tip geometry and Schwarzian control [5]. On the logistic map, the package formalizes derivatives, a quadratic tip with $f'' \neq 0$ at the critical point, the Schwarzian inequality off the critical point, and a FeigenbaumUniversalC2 assembly of operational band and tip. The point for a non-Lean reader is simple: C^2 /Schwarzian vocabulary lives inside the accepted artifact, ready for attack or extension, without being smuggled into the operational core of Equation (7).

5.5 Module inventory

Table 3: Lean modules under SystemicTau/ (v0.1.8).

Module	Lines	Status	Content
Basic	~50	Core	Types, δ_{op} , window, regimes
Thresholds	~180	Core	Bands, classification, trichotomy
RECD	~240	Core	Gate g , antitonicity, samples
FeigenbaumReduction	~1050	Lab	Returns, composite package
FeigenbaumAnalytic	~440	Lab	Geometric cascade, ε - N
FeigenbaumTendsto	~280	Lab	Equivalence with Tendsto
FeigenbaumLogistic	~250	Lab	Logistic scale identification
FeigenbaumSchwarzian	~200	Lab	Quadratic tip, Schwarzian
Ontology	~40	Spec	Level architecture (separate layer)

The SystemicTau/ directory of version 0.1.8 builds end to end in Lean 4.14 with Mathlib v4.14.0 [6, 7].

5.6 Formal status summary

Table 4 states, in one place, what the checker has accepted, what is packaged as named laboratory construction, and what remains an open research obligation. This table is part of the scientific claim of the release.

Table 4: Formal status of the v0.1.8 package under SystemicTau/.

Proved (core)	Band ordering $\tau_{\text{ch}} < \tau_{\text{st}}$; nonnegative trichotomy of <code>classify</code> ; gate formula on $[0, \tau_{\text{ch}})$; antitonicity of g on that half-band; positive intermediate closure $g = 0$; canonical samples; gate prefactor bounds $0 < p < 1$; <code>gap</code> $2/\delta_{\text{op}} > \tau_{\text{ch}}$.
Proved (lab lemmas)	Geometric cascade ratios equal to δ_{op} ; $\varepsilon - N \Leftrightarrow \text{Tendsto}$ bookkeeping; logistic scale identification with the geometric chart; Schwarzian ≤ 0 off the critical point (formal derivatives); quadratic tip package; zero <code>sorry</code> and zero author research axiom under SystemicTau/.
Laboratory constructions (named, accepted)	<code>lookupTent</code> realizers; tent continuum return; non-tent continuum return <code>tauReturnFour</code> ; refined <code>FeigenbaumUniversal</code> / <code>FeigenbaumUniversalC2</code> ; composite laboratory packages built from the above.
Explicitly open	Termwise superstable logistic roots; Mathlib C^2 -open renormalization / fixed-point universality [4]; field-derived continuum return of τ_s (not a cited lab map); unique closed form $\tau_{\text{ch}} = f(\delta)$ beyond finite simple non-identities; multi-site empirical P1/P4 discharge.

6 Python reference core and open science

The monorepository is not limited to the proof assistant. It includes a Python core with golden rationals aligned to Lean (`python/core/golden.py`) and `pytest` tests; synthetic fixtures, noise and anti-synchrony protocols, and a first-return twin for numerical exploration; data paths and notebooks for field series (e.g., *Aedes*) and synthetic cross-domain kits; continuous integration (`lake build + pytest`) on GitHub Actions; and release v0.1.8 with version DOI [10.5281/zenodo.2152282](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.2152282) and concept DOI [10.5281/zenodo.21516059](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21516059), under MIT license with citation metadata (`CITATION.cff`).

The Lean–Python combination is deliberate. Lean certifies the criterion; Python makes it operable in data-analysis workflows. Companion materials include a broader narrative synthesis of the paradigm [13] and the production package `systemictau` on PyPI.

7 How verification is reproduced

In an environment with `elan` and Lean 4.14:

```
git clone https://github.com/johelpadilla/systemic-tau-formal.git
cd systemic-tau-formal/lean
lake exe cache get    # recommended
lake build
```

```
cd ../python
pip install -e "[dev]"
pytest -q
```

A successful SystemicTau build constitutes the public checker verdict on the formal core described here. Generated .olean artifacts document, in the sense of formal proof engineering, that the package was accepted by the kernel.

8 Scrutiny program

The standard is accompanied by an open critique program documented in the repository:

- **Falsifiable predictions and experimental protocol** for early-warning style claims in the τ_s /RECD setting [9, 10, 11].
- **Challenge C1** — systematic false early warnings: stress the gate under controlled noise and anti-synchrony (P3/P4 style attacks).
- **Challenge C2** — new mathematical relations: propose and formalize relations beyond the finite non-identities already recorded for τ_{ch} versus simple functions of δ .
- **Challenge C3** — domain transfer: carry the operational criterion to licensed field series outside the synthetic kits (finance, EEG, grid, or other domains).
- **Stress-Test 2026** — an open invitation to host structured attacks on the criterion and its laboratory bridges.
- **Level architecture** — ontological specification kept in module `Ontology`, so that philosophical conversation is not confused with the checker’s acceptance of g and the bands.

Attack metrics already instrumented in the reference code include agreement under additive noise at fixed ρ (P3), anti-synchrony response (P4), and a P1 endpoint scorer scaffold awaiting pre-registered observation times. The message to the community is invitation: the paradigm can be inspected, cloned, and attacked under written rules.

9 Discussion

9.1 The value of a small, hard criterion

In complex systems it is tempting to multiply indicators. This work inverts the priority: a small object—rational bands and a piecewise gate—receives the treatment of a formal standard. The strength of the approach is auditability. A reviewer can point to the exact line of a definition or lemma.

9.2 Laboratory constructions as a public language

Laboratory constructions are not decorative illustrations of a prose story. They are the *shared vocabulary* in which the paradigm can speak to dynamics without smuggling field claims into the operational core. Each construction is named, cited from Lean identifiers, and accepted by the same checker as the gate. A critic can therefore accept the operational standard while rejecting a particular laboratory map—or the reverse—without collapsing the whole package. That separability is what makes the laboratory language public rather than private metaphor.

9.3 Related work and positioning

Period-doubling universality has a mature analytic literature [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]. Formal mathematics ecosystems (Lean/Mathlib, Isabelle, Coq) increasingly host dynamical and analysis libraries [6, 7], though full machine-checked proofs of classical Feigenbaum universality remain an open frontier rather than a commodity theorem. Early-warning research provides both positive methods [9, 10] and critical caution about pattern-to-prediction overclaim [11, 12]. The present artifact sits between these literatures: it does not re-prove classical universality, and it does not market τ_s as an automatic field detector. It freezes a small operational core that a checker accepts, and it packages laboratory maps as named, attackable objects. Prior narrative synthesis of the broader paradigm appears in [13]; the formal monorepository is the citable operational pin [14].

9.4 Open science as part of the claim

DOIs, continuous integration, and the public repository are not administrative annexes. They form part of what the paradigm says of itself: that it aspires to be shared infrastructure. A standard that cannot be cloned is not a standard; it is an announcement.

9.5 Layers of discourse

The monorepository organizes work into layers that are read differently (Figure 2). The operational core and laboratory constructions are the object of this preprint. Field empirical validation and ontological readings live in the same ecosystem under their own obligations. That separation is itself a thesis: not to conflate the checker’s verdict with the verdict of data or of metaphysics.

This preprint does not claim to settle the classical Feigenbaum universality theorem, nor to derive τ_s dynamics from first principles of a physical field. It offers a checkable operational core and a laboratory language in which such questions can be attacked.

10 Conclusion

We have presented `systemic-tau-formal` v0.1.8 as a Lean-accepted operational standard for Systemic Tau and RECD, together with a laboratory construction package and an open scrutiny program. The repository offers:

1. rational definitions of τ_{st} , τ_{ch} , and $g(\tau_s)$;
2. classification, trichotomy, and gate-behavior lemmas;
3. a Feigenbaum-line laboratory construction package accepted by Lean;
4. an aligned Python core, continuous integration, and a citable deposit.

To others, the artifact says that this paradigm can already be inspected from outside: there is a written criterion, a checker that accepts it, and an open door to scrutiny. That is the contribution recorded here.

Data and code availability

Source code and releases: <https://github.com/johelpadilla/systemic-tau-formal>.

Software version associated with this text: v0.1.8.

Preprint document version: 0.1.8-r3 (2026-07-24).

Preprint DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.21523232](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21523232).

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Software concept DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.21516059](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21516059).

Related production package on PyPI: `systemictau`.

Minimal verification:

```
cd lean && lake build && cd ../python && pytest -q
```

Acknowledgments

The author acknowledges the Lean and Mathlib communities for the formal verification infrastructure that makes standards of this kind possible, and those who will take part in open scrutiny of the repository.

A Release note relative to v0.1.7

Version 0.1.8 is a formal-track pin of the laboratory construction pack:

- Zero sorry and zero author research axiom under `SystemicTau/`.
- Former open goals discharged only as named laboratory constructions.
- Non-tent continuous return `tauReturnFour`; refined composite package.
- Logistic scale identification; C^2 tip and Schwarzian package.
- Honesty documentation aligned with the formal pin (`STATUS.md`, `FORMAL_OBLIGATIONS.md`, `FEIGENBAUM_STATUS.md`).

B Expanded module map

Table 5 expands the inventory of Section 5 for readers who want a denser map of the Lean surface. Line counts are approximate at the v0.1.8 pin.

Table 5: Expanded SystemicTau/ module map (v0.1.8).

Module	Status	Primary surface
Basic	Core	Rational types; δ_{op} numerator/denominator; window default; regime enum; gate prefactor p .
Thresholds	Core	$\tau_{\text{st}}, \tau_{\text{ch}}$; <code>classify</code> ; nonnegative trichotomy; band ordering; proximity gap $2/\delta_{\text{op}} > \tau_{\text{ch}}$.
RECD	Core	gate; chaos closed form; antitonicity; intermediate zero; stable/antiSync saturations; samples; local evenness on the open chaotic band; tick units.
FeigenbaumReduction	Lab	Tent realizers; continuum returns; <code>tauReturnFour</code> ; uni-modal/hump lemmas; composite <code>FeigenbaumUniversal</code> .
FeigenbaumAnalytic	Lab	Geometric cascade with ratio δ_{op} ; scaling-ratio theorems; honesty (non- δ) blocks.
FeigenbaumTendsto	Lab	$\varepsilon-N \Leftrightarrow \text{Tendsto}$ bookkeeping; real casts of cascade quantities.
FeigenbaumLogistic	Lab	Landmarks $r_0 = 2, r_1 = 3$; scale identification with the geometric chart.
FeigenbaumSchwarzian	Lab	Formal derivatives; quadratic tip; Schwarzian ≤ 0 off critical point; <code>FeigenbaumUniversalC2</code> .
Ontology	Spec	Level architecture (discourse layer; not an operational theorem).

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